

BAHI

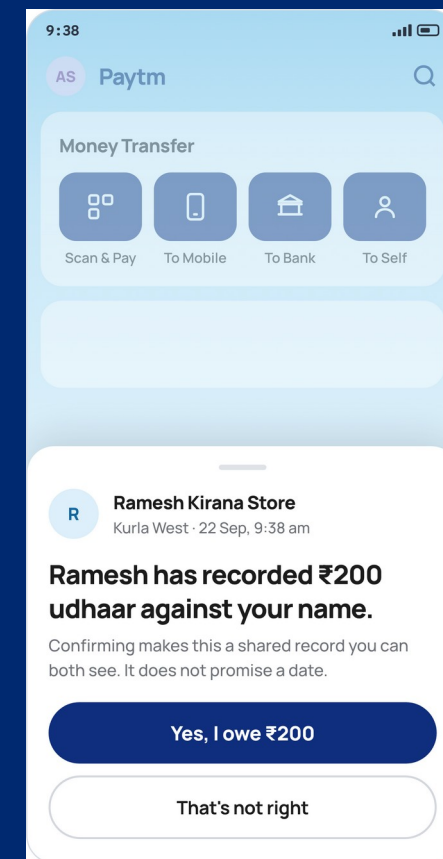
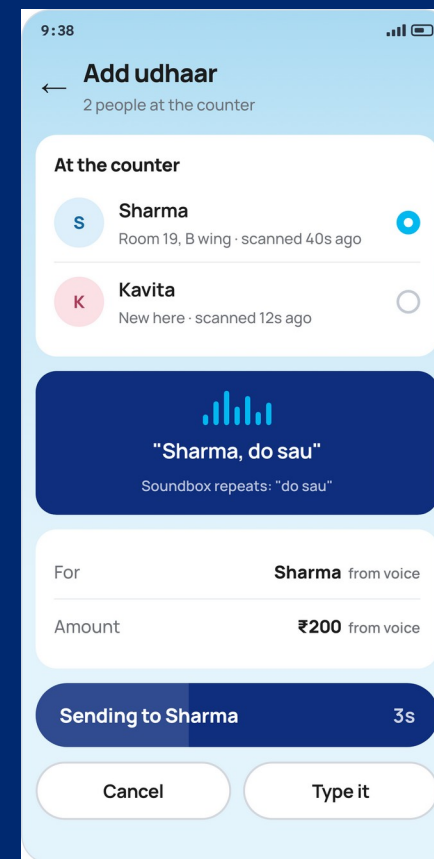
Udhaar, confirmed by both sides.

The customer scans the shop's udhaar QR at the counter. The shopkeeper says the amount to his Soundbox, and the customer confirms it on his own phone. Every night, an agent decides who actually needs a reminder.

Paytm Build for India AI Hackathon · Mumbai, 3 October 2026

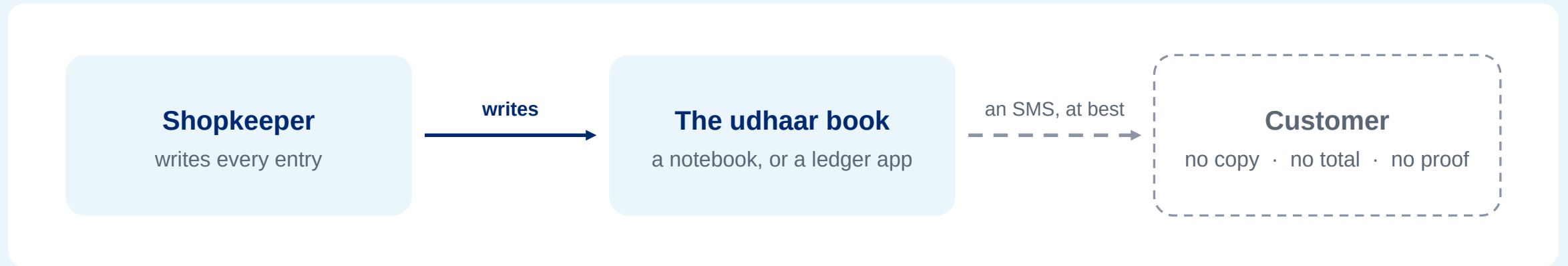
Track 2: AI-Powered Financial Journeys

Team Bitzlab



Shopkeeper's screen · Customer's screen · demo data

The udhaar book has one author. The customer never sees it.



He can't see patterns

Someone who always pays on day 9 and someone quietly drifting away look the same in a notebook. So everyone is chased the same way.

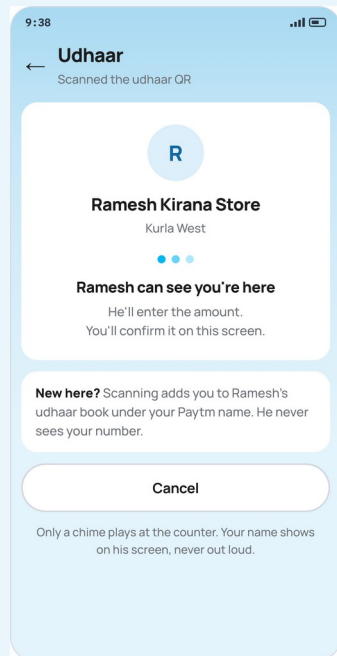
The customer has no record

He can't see what he owes across shops. If the book says ₹500 and he remembers ₹300, he has nothing to show.

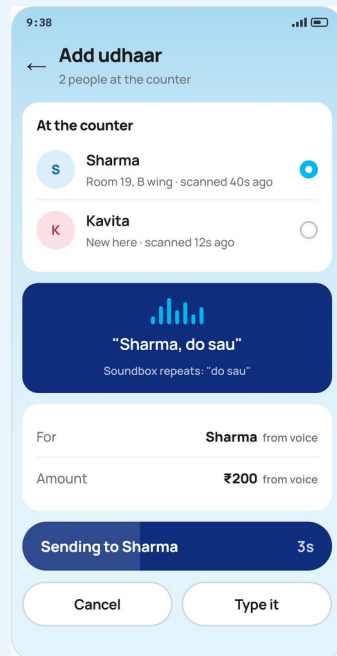
Apps went digital on one side only

Khatabook alone has 5 Cr+ downloads. Its customers still get only an SMS — no app of their own, and no say in the entry.

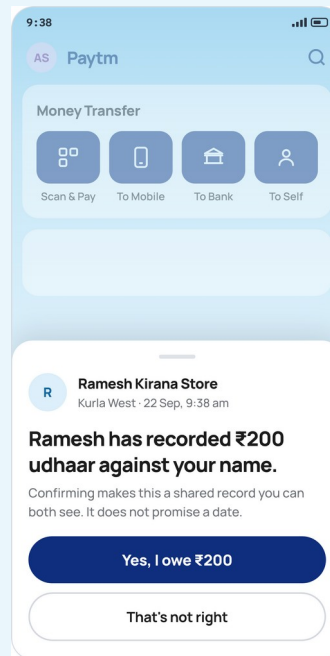
The same book, now confirmed by both sides.



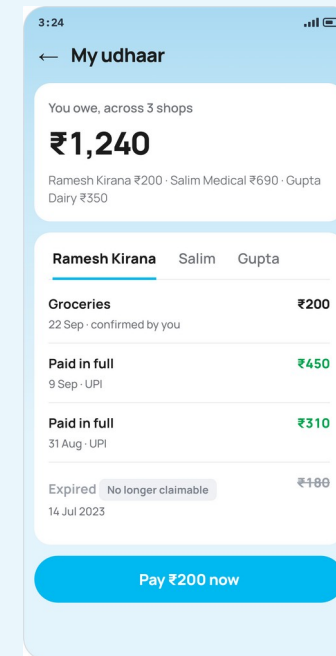
- 1 He scans at the till
A separate udhaar QR, so paying customers never see it.



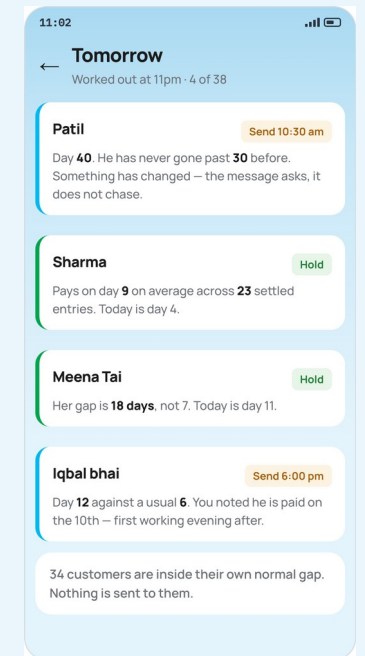
- 2 The shopkeeper says the amount
The scan says who. He says "do sau", or types it.



- 3 Confirmed, right there
"Yes, I owe ₹200", on the phone in his hand.



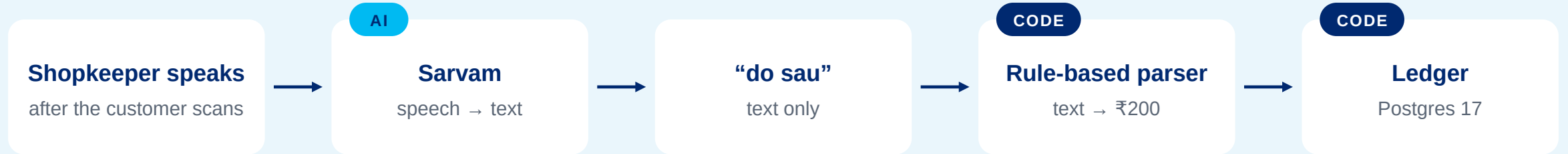
- 4 He sees every shop
One total across his shops, one tap to pay.



- 5 The agent picks the day
Sharma pays on day 9, so on day 4 he hears nothing.

AI hears the words. Plain code decides every number.

DURING THE DAY — RECORDING AN ENTRY



EVERY NIGHT — DECIDING WHO HEARS FROM US



How we prove it: a test fails the build if the core logic imports any AI or database code. The model only ever returns text.

STACK

Next.js 16

React 19

FastAPI

Python 3.13

Postgres 17

Sarvam

Cognee

n8n

Every udhaar app serves the shopkeeper. We add the customer.

	DOWNLOADS	CUSTOMER HAS AN APP	CUSTOMER CONFIRMS ENTRIES
Khatabook	5 Cr+	No — SMS / WhatsApp	No
OkCredit	1 Cr+	No — “They don’t need the app”	No
Paytm Business Khata	Inside Paytm for Business	No — SMS with a pay link	No
Done	100+	Yes	Yes — by OTP
BAHI	—	Yes — inside the Paytm app	Yes — one tap

Two-sided

An entry becomes a fact only when the customer confirms it.

Scan, then speak

The QR says who, his voice says how much. Nothing to type.

Timed per person

Reminders follow each customer’s own repayment pattern.

Fewer reminders, sent only to people who are actually late.

4 of 38

customers who owe get a reminder tonight.

The other 34 are not late by their own pattern, so they hear nothing.

Our demo shop: 60 customers, six months of synthetic data.

For the shopkeeper

Stops chasing people who always pay.

Spots the ones who are drifting.

Records by voice, so the queue keeps moving.

For the customer

Sees his total across every shop.

Has proof of every entry.

Is reminded privately, not at the counter.

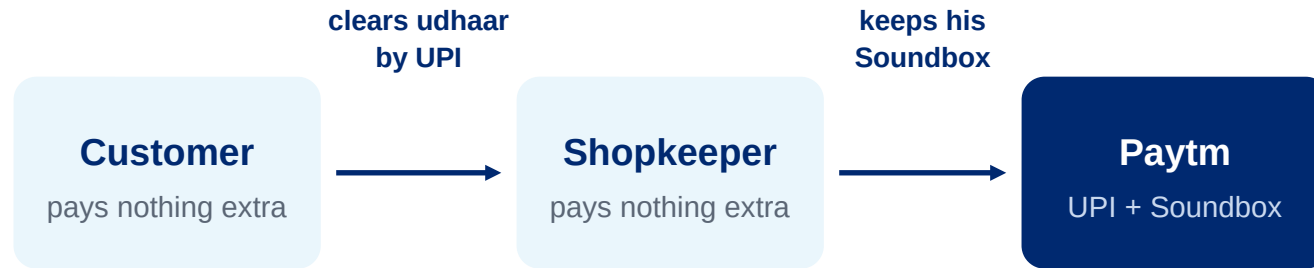
For Paytm

Udhaar settled in cash moves to UPI.

A daily reason to use the Soundbox.

A new reason to open the Paytm app.

Free for both sides. Paytm gains through the Soundbox.



1.57 Cr

storefronts already run a Paytm Soundbox — the counter BAHU lives on.

Source: Paytm Q1 FY27 earnings release, Jul 2026

What Paytm gets

- Udhaar repayments move from cash to Paytm UPI.
- A reason for merchants to keep their Soundbox subscription.
- Later, with consent: a repayment history for people with no credit file. We only record it — licensed partners would lend.

₹116 Cr

Khatabook's FY24 loss, on ₹102.7 Cr revenue. Charging for a ledger has not worked, so we don't.

Source: YourStory, Nov 2024

Four things BAHF refuses to do, each from Indian law.

1

No due dates

Customers tap “Yes, I owe ₹200” — never “I’ll pay by the 10th”.

Why: A dated promise can be a promissory note, which the IT Act does not cover.

IT Act 2000, s.1(4) & First Schedule

2

No fees, no interest

Never a rupee above the price. There is no fee field anywhere.

Why: Money-lending laws define a loan by the interest it carries.

e.g. Karnataka Money Lenders Act 1961, s.2(9)

3

No debt kept alive forever

We never ask a customer to re-confirm an old debt just to keep it alive.

Why: Each written acknowledgment restarts the 3-year limit.

Limitation Act 1963, s.18

4

No shaming, no pressure

No defaulter lists, no public alerts, no “demand” button.

Why: Public labels risk defamation; repeated nudges for gain are “nagging”.

BNS 2023, s.356 · CCPA Dark Patterns Guidelines 2023

A 40-second demo, and what could go wrong.

The demo

- 1 A judge scans our udhaar QR.
- 2 The shopkeeper says the amount.
- 3 The judge confirms on their own phone.
- 4 Both books update, live.
- 5 The agent says who gets a reminder tonight, and why.

All data is synthetic and labelled on screen. A browser microphone stands in for the Soundbox.

RISK	HOW WE HANDLE IT
Wrong amount, or wrong person	Both are shown before sending, and the customer must confirm, so a mistake is never silent.
Venue wifi fails	Deployed publicly, so the judge’s phone uses its own data. Speech is cached offline.
The customer never confirms	The entry stays in the shopkeeper’s book, marked unconfirmed.
Reminders feel like pressure	Timed per person, private and rare. There is no demand button.

Where every fact in this deck comes from.

MARKET AND PRODUCTS

Khatabook — 5 Cr+ downloads; customers get SMS / WhatsApp

[Google Play, checked 23 Sep 2026](#)

OkCredit — 1 Cr+ downloads; “They don’t need the app”

[Google Play and okcredit.in, checked 23 Sep 2026](#)

Done — 100+ downloads; entries confirmed by OTP

[Google Play, checked 23 Sep 2026](#)

Paytm Business Khata — customer reminders by SMS with a pay link

[business.paytm.com, checked 23 Sep 2026](#)

Paytm Soundbox “deployed at 1.57 Cr storefronts”

[Paytm Q1 FY2027 earnings release, 20 Jul 2026](#)

Khatabook FY24 — ₹102.7 Cr revenue, ₹116 Cr loss

[YourStory, Nov 2024](#)

LAW

Information Technology Act 2000, s.1(4) and First Schedule, entry 1 (as amended 2022)

Negotiable instruments other than cheques are outside the Act.

Karnataka Money Lenders Act 1961, s.2(9)

A “loan” is an advance at interest, of money or in kind.

Limitation Act 1963, s.18

A written acknowledgment starts a fresh limitation period.

Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023, s.356

Defamation.

CCPA Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns 2023, Annexure 1, item 10

“Nagging”.